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VISUAL STUDIO 2.1. REFLECTION

For this assignment, I chose watercolor painting as my first medium because I like how it uses soft colors and blending to create a peaceful and natural-looking image. I wanted to create a landscape with a small cabin in the woods, surrounded by trees, flowers, mountains and a lake. I thought this would be a good subject because it allows me to use different colors, shapes, lines and textures. When I switched to linocut printing, the image changed in several ways. The watercolor version had softer edges, lighter colors, and blended areas. The linocut version had stronger lines, darker areas, and more contrast. Even though both images showed the same cabin & landscape, they had different appearances because of the materials and processes used. I learned that each medium communicates differently. Watercolor creates a softer and more relaxed feeling because the colors can mix and flow together. Linocut printing creates a bolder appearance because the image is made by carving designs into a surface and transforming ink into paper. One possibility I discovered with watercolor is that I can create different shades and blend colors to make the artwork look more natural. However, it can be difficult to control where the paint spreads. With linocut, I can create strong outlines and interesting textures, but I have less freedom to blend colors and create soft details. The tools and processes played an important role in how each image turned out. Watercolor brushes and water helped create soft layers, while carving tools and printing ink helped create bold shapes and lines. Overall, switching to printmaking changed how I interpreted the artwork. The watercolor version felt calm and welcoming, while the linocut version felt stronger and more dramatic. This assignment helped me understand how different artistic mediums can communicate different feelings even when the subject and composition stay the same.